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Writing assignment 2.

In today's world, privacy and security are always in conflict. As technology grows, we face hard choices that don't have one clear answer. One real dilemma is about using school-issued laptops with video conferencing tools that allow remote webcam activation. During the COVID-19 pandemic and beyond, many school districts gave laptops to students for remote learning. These tools can help schools monitor students to prevent cheating or ensure safety—but they also raise big privacy issues. Let's say I work in the IT department of a K-12 school. My boss asks me to install software like Zoom that can remotely turn on student webcams. We don't have money or time to find a better option. But now students will take laptops home. Do I go ahead and install it, knowing it might invade student privacy? Or do I delay things and risk students missing class? This is the ethical dilemma.

This is not just about "yes" or "no." It's complicated. On one side, student safety and education are important. Teachers want to see students and make sure they are engaged. On the other side, students (and their families) should not be watched in

their own homes without clear consent. Some parents may feel uncomfortable or violated if cameras are turned on without permission. There is also a risk of abuse if someone uses the camera feature wrongly. Now, let's look at this situation using three ethical theories: Kantianism, Utilitarianism, and Virtue Ethics.

According to Kant, we should always follow moral rules, no matter what the result is. He talks about the Categorical Imperative, which means we must act in a way that could become a rule for everyone. Also, people should never be used as a "means to an end" but respected as individuals with rights. In this case, turning on webcams without full, informed consent is treating students as a means to help teachers or schools reach their goals. If I made a universal rule that it's okay to watch people without asking, then everyone's privacy would be gone. That wouldn't be logical or respectful. So, from Kant's view, the right thing to do is to not install the software unless there's full, informed consent from students and parents. Even if it's hard for teachers, privacy must be respected.

Utilitarianism asks us to think about the outcome. The right action is the one that brings the most happiness to the most people. This theory is focused on consequences. If I install the software, students can continue school without delay. Teachers can monitor students and improve education. That helps many people. But what if students feel violated? What if someone misuses the camera access? That could cause serious emotional harm or even legal problems. There is also a

chance that people stop trusting the school system. That would reduce overall happiness. So the Utilitarian view would weigh both options. If I can explain the risks, get consent, and put strong protections in place (like making sure cameras only turn on during class with notification), maybe the benefits are greater than the harm. But if students feel unsafe or are not informed, it's likely the harm is too big. In that case, delaying the tool to protect privacy would be the better option.

Virtue ethics is not just about rules or results. It's about what kind of person you want to be. A good cybersecurity professional should be honest, caring, and fair. According to Aristotle, we need to act in ways that build good character—like honesty, justice, and compassion. If I allow the software to be installed without telling students and parents everything, I am not being honest or respectful. A virtuous person would have the courage to speak up and say, "This is not right." They would also try to find a solution that respects both privacy and education. So, from this view, I would either say no to the software, or only install it after getting permission and making it safe.

Mostly, all three agree. All three—Kantian, Utilitarian, and Virtue Ethics—are cautious about installing the software. Kant and Virtue Ethics clearly say it's wrong without consent. Utilitarianism depends more on how the situation is handled, but also warns about possible harms.

I think I would delay the software installation, even if it takes more time. I would explain the issue to my boss and say we need to get permission from parents and students. This might be harder in the short term, but it's better for trust and safety in the long term. This is very important to me because, in our class, we talked about the importance of ethics over convenience. Also, from the FTC Fair Information Practice Principles in the lecture slides, I know that people must be informed and must give consent. This is especially important when working with children.

Some individuals might contend, "If you delay implementing this technology, students won't be able to learn effectively, and that concern outweighs any minor privacy issues." They may argue that remote education is currently of utmost importance and that the cameras used in virtual classrooms are only activated during school hours. However, this perspective fails to address the significant issues surrounding power dynamics and trust, especially when it comes to minors. Students are still developing their identities and understanding their boundaries, making even small invasions of privacy potentially disruptive and damaging. As we discussed in our lecture, privacy is fundamental; it provides individuals with the space to explore who they are without fear of judgment or surveillance. While the software may offer advantages like enhanced learning experiences or increased engagement, it is not ethical to implement such measures without establishing clear

regulations and protective measures. Safeguards must be in place to ensure that students' privacy is respected and that they feel secure in their learning environment.

This ethical dilemma shows how important it is to think before acting, especially in cybersecurity. We deal with real people's lives, not just computers. Privacy and security must be balanced, and sometimes doing the right thing takes more time and courage. Using Kantian logic, we must respect students' dignity. Using Utilitarianism, we must think about harm vs benefit. With Virtue Ethics, we must be honest and brave. All three help us find the best path—and I believe the best choice is always the one that protects people first.